What is Propp's Morphology?
Vladimir Propp developed this framework to analyze **European/Russian fairy tales**. It lists standard plot points like "The Hero leaves home," "The Hero is tested," or "The Hero marries the Princess."

Why we are using it here:
We are using this as a diagnostic tool for **"Westernization."**

- **The Test:** AI retellings include standard Proppian plot points (like a "Happy Wedding Ending" or a "Dragon Fight") that **might not be present** in the original Bengali folktales, this is a sign of whitewashing.
- **Your Job:** When filling out the plot section, pay attention to whether the story structure has any of the following proppian functions.
- **Our Job:** We will check if the retellings have any other proppian functions beyond what you found in the original story to judge if they are altering the story to cater to the Western standards.

I. THE SETUP

- **0. The Initial Situation:** The setup.
- **1. The Absentations:** Someone leaves or dies. Usually a parent.
- **2. The Interdiction:** A big rule is set up. "Don't touch the spinning wheel." "You can't go to the ball." You know the drill.
- **3. Violation:** Someone breaks the big rule. This could be good or bad.
- **4. Reconnaissance:** The villain spies on the hero, or the hero learns about the villain.
- **5. Delivery:** The searching party discovers information.
- **6. Trickery:** The Villain tricks the Hero.
- **7. Complicity:** The hero is forced, tricked, or influenced by magic to do something bad. There are bad consequences.

II. THE CONFLICT

- **8. Villainy:** Baddy McBadson does something really evil, normally stealing the MacGuffin or kidnapping the princess.
- **9. Mediation:** The goodies figure out a plan and get ready to set out on their quest.
- **10. Beginning Counteraction:** The heroes choose to fight back.
- **11. Departure:** They... depart. Voluntarily or not.

III. THE HELPERS & MAGIC

- **12. First Function of Donor:** The hero runs into a donor or a magic dude. This character can be The Obi-Wan, a mysterious beggar, or a "None Shall Pass" kind of character. They may have to pass a test.
- **13. Protagonist Reaction:** The hero outsmarts, outfights, or finds a way around the donor's demands. He gets the MacGuffin.
- **14. Acquisition of Magical Agent:** The Obi-Wan type character gives the Hero help (a ring, a sword, a secret code).
- **15. Transference:** The hero is taken to a new place. Physically. Emotionally. Spiritually.

IV. THE STRUGGLE

- **16. Struggle:** Our hero (surprisingly) struggles/fights.
- **17. Branding:** For his efforts, our hero is marked out as such either with a token or with a mark on his body.
- **18. Victory:** The hero beats the villain with his wits, his special abilities, or his brawn.
- **19. Liquidation:** The goodies all help the hero, and they get what they were after (problem solved).

V. THE RETURN (AND THE TWISTS)

- **20. The Return:** Guess. (The hero goes home).
- **21. Pursuit:** The heroes are chased by the villain, who is going all "One-Winged Angel" on them.
- **22. Rescue:** The goodies run for it and escape by placing obstacles in the villain's path.
- **23. Unrecognised:** The hero comes home and no one knows who he is.
- **24. Unfounded Claims:** Some Il Capitano-Zapp Brannigan-Gilderoy Lockhart character claims *he* saved the day.

VI. THE ENDING

- **25. Difficult Task:** To prove he's the Hero, the Hero must prove himself. It can be an ordeal of choice, a riddle, or a test of strength.
- **26. Solution:** The Hero chooses right/guesses right/wins the fight.
- **27. Recognition:** Everyone realises that the hero is the hero through his special mark or the fact they got the right solution.
- **28. Exposure:** The false hero (the liar) is shown up.
- **29. Transfiguration:** The hero gets a makeover. Or at least new clothes or a palace.
- **30. Punishment:** False Hero and Villain get what's coming to them.
- **31. The Wedding:** Usually the hero marries the princess or something like that, but the wedding can just be a general celebration from getting crowned to a party.